

Reader's Guide to the Executive Budget

Volume II Operating Detail

Organization of the State Government

The state government's organizational structure as set forth in the West Virginia Constitution consists of three main branches: executive, legislative, and judicial. The executive branch contains the following constitutional offices: Governor's Office, Auditor's Office, Treasurer's Office, Department of Agriculture, Attorney General, and Secretary of State's Office. The legislative branch is made up of the Senate and the House of Delegates. The judicial branch consists of the Supreme Court of Appeals. See the graphic at the end of this section.

The West Virginia Code has further organized the executive branch into 12 departments (Administration; Commerce; Economic Development; Education; Arts, Culture and History; Environmental Protection; Health and Human Resources; Homeland Security and Emergency Management; Revenue; Tourism; Transportation; and Veterans Assistance) and one bureau (Senior Services). The remaining units are organized into either Higher Education or Miscellaneous Boards and Commissions.

The Executive Budget

The Governor is mandated by the West Virginia Constitution to submit a budget for the upcoming fiscal year to the Legislature and to the citizens of the State. The Executive Budget presents a complete plan of estimated revenues and proposed expenditures for the upcoming fiscal year, any recommendations the Governor may desire to make as to the important features of the budget, and any suggestions as to methods for reduction or increase of the State's revenues.

In essence, the budget is the means by which the Governor presents a continuous and timely flow of accurate information relative to the financial condition of the State, as well as relevant information concerning the needs and operations of the various state agencies and departments.

The budget is presented in four separate documents. The **Budget Bill** includes the language required to legally enact the budget or appropriations bill. Upon passage by the Legislature, the Budget Bill becomes the Budget Act and appropriates by spending unit the expenditures necessary for the economical and efficient discharge of the duties and responsibilities of the State and its agencies during the upcoming fiscal year.

Volume I Budget Report contains:

"Financial Statements"—Provides information on estimated receipts and disbursements and fund balances such as:

- * A combined statement of revenues, expenditures, and changes in fund balances for all funds;
- * The recommended appropriations from the General, Federal, Special, Lottery, and State Road funds, including any recommended supplemental or surplus appropriations;
- * Cash and investment balances of all funds;
- * Summary of primary government long-term debt outstanding;
- * Major Reserve/Stabilization Accounts.

"Budget Planning"—items such as:

- * "Long-Range Issues"—an overview of how the State is addressing major long-range issues and concerns.
- * "Budget Overview" that includes the budget process, including the budget calendar and financial policies.
- * Schedules of budgeted, full-time equivalent permanent positions.

"Revenue Sources"—A detailed explanation of major revenue sources and the distribution of funds.

"Debt Summary"—information relating to the general, special, and moral obligations of the State, including a summary of general long-term debt and debt service requirements.